

Diagnostics waiting over six weeks

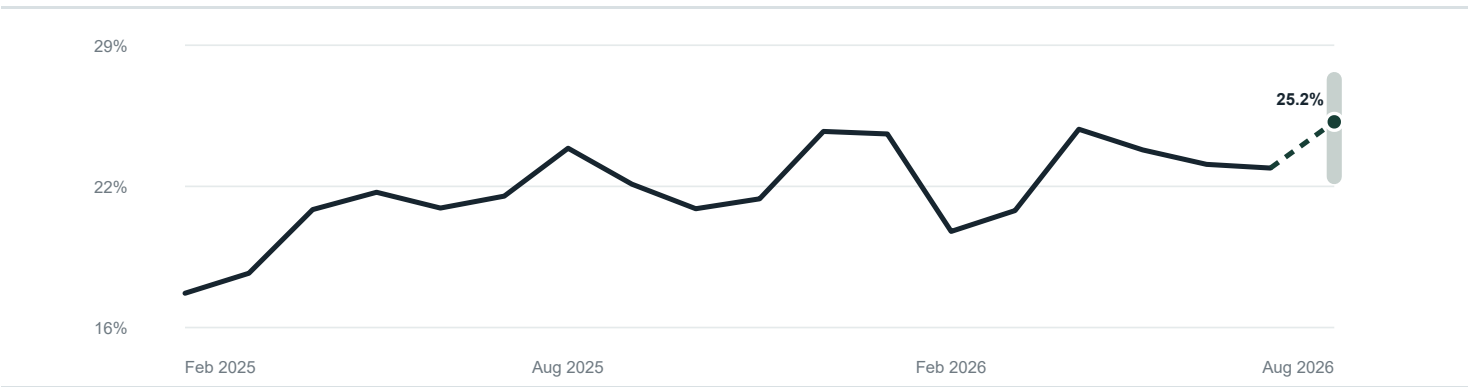
Forecast for August 2026 · data through July 2026

Diagnostics waiting over six weeks is forecast to deteriorate at the next release, from 23.1% to 25.2%. The model's expected deterioration is mainly due to the usual month-to-month seasonal movement; the underlying trend is broadly flat. The current projection is off course for 14% or less by March 2027. Sustained favourable/adverse provider signals: 35/30.

LATEST · JULY 2026	OUTLOOK · AUGUST 2026	ACTUAL
23.1%	25.2%	
No archived pre-release forecast	80% range 22.7%–27.2%	Not yet released
		Off course · 14% or less by March 2027

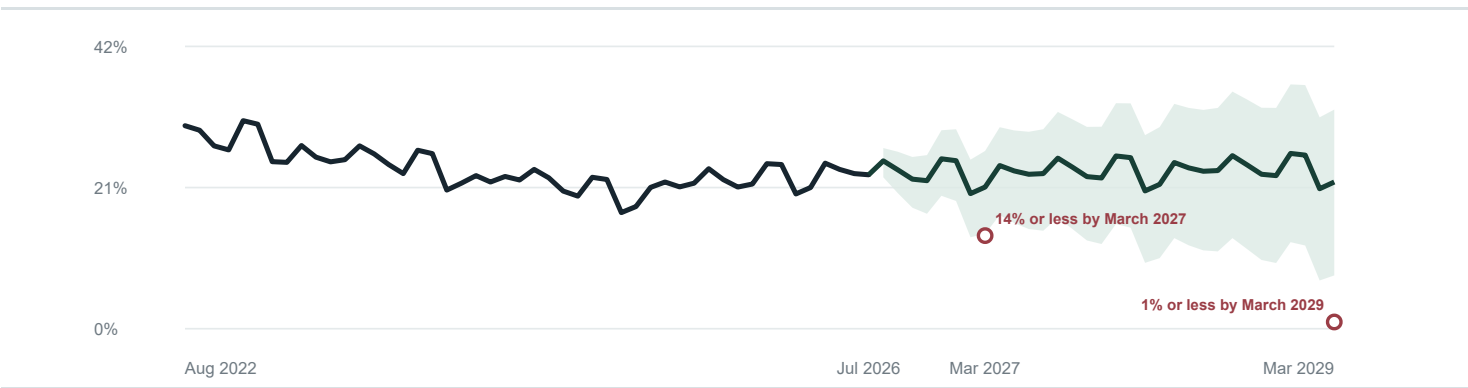
Recent performance and next release

The vertical band is the 80% expected range.



Longer-term outlook and milestones

Descriptive projection; not forced to meet targets.



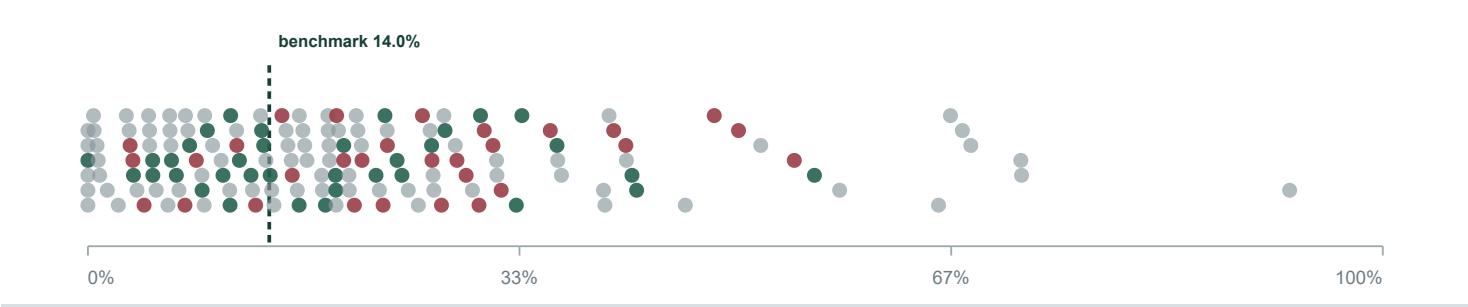
Benchmark: 1% operational standard. 7.3pp above milestone
Data: NHS England diagnostic waiting times and activity. **Targets:** Medium Term Planning Framework national target · Medium Term Planning Framework final target
Method: Backtest-weighted ensemble of current-level seasonal movement, damped annual drift and a damped recent seasonal trend; at least 2 components are required. The final fit uses 247 consecutive months. Accuracy is tested on 36 rolling one-month-ahead forecasts. The 80% range uses empirical historical error quantiles from 36 forecast errors. Weights use inverse rolling RMSE and are shrunk toward equal weights. The pre-release commentary compares the current-level seasonal component with the combined forecast. Provider distribution and trajectory watch are shown on page 2.

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Distribution and trajectory watch · July 2026

Provider distribution

Latest reported performance across providers. This is a comparison of current levels, not a measure of whether each provider is improving or deteriorating.



Trajectory watch

Signals show sustained departures from each provider's own archived outlook. A low performer can be improving, and a high performer can be deteriorating. Status: Sufficient national and provider history.

142 providers assessed	35 sustained favourable	30 sustained adverse	77 without an active signal
Largest sustained favourable moves		Largest sustained adverse moves	
Royal Surrey NHS Foundation Trust Latest 8.8% · 6 consecutive releases assessed historically simulated	20.2pp SIX-MONTH GAP	East Kent Hospitals University NHS Foundation Trust Latest 48.4% · 6 consecutive releases assessed historically simulated	14.7pp SIX-MONTH GAP
King's College Hospital NHS Foundation Trust Latest 19.1% · 6 consecutive releases assessed historically simulated	18.7pp SIX-MONTH GAP	Cambridge University Hospitals NHS Foundation Trust Latest 26.6% · 6 consecutive releases assessed historically simulated	14.5pp SIX-MONTH GAP
West Suffolk NHS Foundation Trust Latest 19.1% · 6 consecutive releases assessed historically simulated	18.4pp SIX-MONTH GAP	Dorset Healthcare University NHS Foundation Trust Latest 31.9% · 6 consecutive releases assessed historically simulated	13.1pp SIX-MONTH GAP
Trajectory-watch rule. Six consecutive release surprises are compared with forecasts made before each release. A signal requires a material average gap, at least five of six months in the same direction, and the latest month confirming that direction. These are screening prompts—not league tables, causal estimates or judgements of provider quality.			